Ruoxi Zhang

Email: ruoxi.zhang@epfl.ch | Tel: +41 762760634

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL) Sep. 2024–Jun. 2027 (expected)
Master's Degree in Management, Technology and Entrepreneurship **GPA: 5.48/6.00**

University of Electronic Science and Technology of China Sep. 2020–Jun. 2024
Dual Bachelor's Degrees in Electronic Information Engineering and E-Commerce **GPA: 3.98/4.00**

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

[1] **Zhang, R.**, Fang, J., Han, L., and Liao, M. (2026). Is more human-like better? The impact of virtual streamer language naturalness on user engagement. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 222, 124392. **(ABS 3; SSCI Q1)**

[2] Li, L., **Zhang, R.**, Zeng, S., and Shrestha, Y. R. (2026). Who Stays When AI Answers? Core-Periphery Resilience in Online Knowledge Communities. *International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*. **(Accepted)**

[3] **Zhang, R.** and Ren, C. (2024). Sentiment time series clustering of Danmu videos based on BERT fine-tuning and SBD-K-shape. *The Electronic Library*, 42(4), 553–575. **(SSCI Q2)**

[4] Li, X., **Zhang, R.**, Sun, M., Zhang, S., Zhu, H., and Li, X. (2026). AdStudio: A Strategy-Guided System for Controllable Human-AI Co-Creation of Short Video Ads. **(Under review at ACM CHI 2027)**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

HEC Paris Jun. 2026–Sep. 2026
Supervisor: **Xitong Li** Information Systems and Operations Management

AdStudio: A Strategy-Guided System for Controllable Human–AI Co-Creation of Short Video Ads

- Designed and implemented AdStudio, a human–AI co-creation system that helps creators translate advertising strategies into short video ads while retaining control over the generation process.
- Developed a RAG-based pipeline for advertising strategy generation using a knowledge base of 3,930 TikTok beauty ads. Designed an interactive workflow supporting strategy selection, iterative refinement of scripts and video segments, and automatic video assembly.
- Designed an evaluation with 12 creators and 150 audience participants, showing improvements in overall creator experience, strategy adoption, and perceived control, as well as audience-perceived ad quality.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

University of Lausanne (UNIL) Sep. 2025–Jun. 2026
Supervisor: **Yash Raj Shrestha** Applied Artificial Intelligence Lab (AAIL)

Who Stays When AI Answers? Core-Periphery Resilience in Online Knowledge Communities

- Examined how ChatGPT's release reshaped participation and contribution in online knowledge communities, focusing on differences between core and peripheral users across programming and mathematics communities.
- Applied UMAP and HDBSCAN to identify core and peripheral users based on pre-release behavioral profiles, then estimated DID and DDD models using 52-week panel data covering 558,980 users across Stack Overflow and Mathematics Stack Exchange.
- Documented sharper participation declines among peripheral than core users, especially on Stack Overflow. Active peripheral users showed larger increases in the average length of their contributions than core users.

University of Electronic Science and Technology of China Sep. 2023–Jun. 2024
Supervisor: **Jiaming Fang** Department of Data Science and Intelligent Management

Is more human-like better? The impact of virtual streamer language naturalness on user engagement

- Investigated how virtual streamers' text and voice naturalness relate to user engagement in livestreaming commerce, and how anthropomorphic appearance moderates these relationships.
- Constructed text and voice naturalness measures using BERTScore, NISQA, and acoustic feature analysis. Conducted econometric analysis (negative binomial regression) using data from 394 Taobao livestreams to examine the relationships between language naturalness and user engagement.
- Found that text naturalness was negatively associated with user engagement, whereas voice naturalness was positively associated. Anthropomorphic appearance weakened the negative association and strengthened the positive association.

HONORS & AWARDS

Outstanding Graduate, University of Electronic Science and Technology of China	2024
First-Class Outstanding Scholarship, UESTC	2021–2024
Samsung Scholarship	2023
National Second Prize, 13th National College Students' E-Commerce "Innovation, Creativity and Entrepreneurship" Challenge	2023
Provincial Gold Award, 8th China International "Internet+" College Students' Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition	2022

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

- **Programming and tools:** Python, R, Stata, SQL, MATLAB, Hadoop, and LaTeX.
- **Languages:** Mandarin (native); English (IELTS 8.0: Listening 9.0, Reading 8.5, Writing 6.5, Speaking 7.0).
- **Standardized Test:** GRE General Test: 327 (Quantitative 170, Verbal 157).